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PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

FIRST MEETING, 2026

Friday, 6th February, 2026

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:27 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I crave your indulgence to take the item numbered 5, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report* of Thursday, 5th February, 2026.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 1...8—

Yes, Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah?

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

On the page numbered 7, I have been marked absent. Yesterday I was here briefly, signed, and so I am surprised that my name is not in the list.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I notice his presence. Table Office, kindly take note and make the correction.

Page 8—

Yes, Mr Frank Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

On the item numbered 6, line 3, I propose we delete the first word which is “Tuesday” and insert the word “Wednesday”, since the second Sitting of this Meeting was held on 4th February, 2026.

Mr Speaker, I am aware it is your special day. Happy birthday, Mr Speaker. You have been a great blessing to this country and a great inspiration to us in Ghana’s legislative jurisprudence—*[Interruption]*—Yes, it is part of the *Votes and Proceedings*. God bless you so much. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Member. Table Office, kindly take note.

Page 9...16.

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 6th February, 2026, as presented and corrected is hereby adopted as a true record of proceedings.

We now turn to the *Official Report*. I have in my hand the *Official Report* of Wednesday, 17th December, 2025, for your corrections.

Hon Members, any corrections?

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 17th December, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader?

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, today being Friday, I think, if you so direct, I would present the Business Statement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. The Business Statement by the Chairperson of the Business Committee, who happens to be the Majority Leader and Leader of Government Business. You have the floor.

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

Chairperson of the Business Committee/ Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Thank you very much.

Mr Speaker, let me join Hon Colleagues to wish you a very happy birthday. From here, we would go to your office. We expect a very fat cake. Those of us who take delight in some types of beverages, we expect many of those in your office today.

All those who have birthday gifts, should please hand them over to me. I will account to the Hon First Deputy

Speaker on all birthday gifts that will be presented. The most important Business today is to celebrate the birthday of the First Deputy Speaker.

Mr Speaker, the Committee met yesterday, Thursday, 5th February, 2026 and arranged Business of the House for the Second Week ending Friday, 13th February, 2026.

Mr Speaker, the Committee accordingly submits its report as follows:

Arrangement of Business

Formal Communications by the Speaker

Mr Speaker, you may read any available communication to the House.

Question(s)

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee has scheduled the following Ministers to respond to Questions asked of them during the Week:

No. of Question(s)

i. Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment	4
ii. Minister for Food and Agriculture	8
iii. Minister for Roads and Highways	10
iv. Minister for Transport	4
v. Minister of State in Charge of Government Communications	2
vi. Minister for Health	10
vii. Minister for Sports and Recreation	1
viii. Minister for Environment, Science and Technology	7
ix. Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts	4

Total Number of Questions

50

Mr Speaker, in all, nine (9) Ministers are expected to attend upon the House to respond to Fifty (50) Questions during the Week. The Questions are of the following types:

- i. Urgent – 1; ii. Oral – 49

Statements

Mr Speaker, pursuant to Order 91(2), Ministers of State may be permitted to make Statements on Government policy. You may also admit Statements by Hon Members in accordance with Order 93.

Guidelines on making Statements

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee takes the opportunity to remind Hon Members on the guidelines to making Statements in the House. Hon Ministers are expected to deliver Statements within 15 minutes; Hon Members, excluding Leaders, within 10 minutes; and 5 minutes for each Member contributing. Attached is a detailed Guidelines to making Statements.

Bills, Papers and Reports

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 159, Bills may be presented to the House for First Reading. However, those of urgent nature may be taken through the various stages in a day in accordance with Order 160.

Pursuant to Order 97, Papers may be laid during the week and reports from Committees may also be presented to the House for consideration.

Motions and Resolutions

Mr Speaker, Motions may be debated and their consequential Resolutions, if any, taken during the week.

Referral at Committee

Mr Speaker, the Business Committee, once again remind the House of the backlog of referrals pending before Committees. Leadership of Committees are, therefore, urged to prioritise and expedite consideration of the referrals and promptly report to the House during the Meeting in accordance with Order 267 (4).

Conclusion

Mr Speaker, in accordance with Order 216 (2) and subject to Order 67, the Committee submits to the House the order in which the Business of the House shall be taken during the week.

Mr Ayariga: The Business Committee took a view that a lot of the Statements tend to be long winding and

comments also take a lot of time, so there needs to be some agreement regarding how long a Statement should last so that we can manage time in the House.

Mr Speaker, Business Committee takes the opportunity to remind Hon Members on the guidelines to making Statements in the House. They are expected to deliver Statements within 15 minutes. Attached is a detailed guideline to making Statements. The last page of the Business Statement has the details of the guidelines so let us try and live within that.

Tuesday, 10th February, 2026

Roll Call

National Pledge

Statements

(a) **Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe (Ada):** To make a Statement on domestic violence.

(b) **Ms Helen Adjoa Ntoso (Krachi West):** To make a Statement on Volta Lake Disaster.

(c) **Mrs Dr Stephen Amoah (Nhyiaeso):** To make a Statement on making Entrepreneurship part of Ghana's Basic and SHS Academic Curricula.

Questions

Q.470. Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta): To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what

proactive measures the Ministry is taking on labour upheavals that has become rife lately in the country.

Q.503. Mr Tweneboah Kodua Fokua (Manso Nkwanta): To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what the Ministry is using to track employment growth and if these targets area being met.

Q.504. Mr Tweneboah Kodua Fokua (Manso Nkwanta): To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what is being done to improve occupational health and safety standards, especially in high-risk industries like construction and mining.

Q.657 Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (Manso Nkwanta): To ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment the status of the Work Abroad Programme.

Q.433. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what measures are being taken to control pests and diseases in crops and livestock.

Q.428. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what initiatives have been implemented to boost agricultural production and increase farmers' income.

Q.431. Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (Keta): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture how the government is strengthening extension services to provide farmers with information on best practices.

Q.465. Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (Kwabre East): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what the Ministry intends to do to address the volatility of the world market prices of cashew and its impacts on farm gate prices and exports.

Q.528. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the plans to enhance the poultry value chain from production to processing and value addition, marketing and distribution and consumption and demand.

Q.530. Mr Anthony Mmieh (Odotobri): To ask the Minister Food and Agriculture what interventions the Ministry is undertaking to ensure fair and equitable distribution of food nationwide in the light of the increasing cost of foodstuff across the country especially in mining communities.

Q.529. Mr Anthony Mmieh (Odotobri): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what specific measures are currently being implemented to enhance the oil palm industry in Ghana particularly in the processing sector, given that the Minerals Commission has distributed millions of oil palm seedlings since 2019

Q.659. Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (Garu): To ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the status of the stalled Tamne Irrigation Project in Garu, the steps the Ministry is implementing to ensure its completion and when it is expected to be completed.

Presentation of Papers

- (a) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Intestate Succession Bill, 2025.
- (b) Report of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs on the Governance Advisory Council Bill, 2025.

Motions

Committee Sitings

Wednesday, 11th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

- (a) **Mr Eric Edem Agbana (Ketu North):** To make a Statement on population and development: Shaping Ghana's Development.
- (b) **Ms Laurette Korkor Asante (Atiwa West):** To make a Statement on Emergency Care in Ghana; A Lack Thereof.
- (c) **Mr Ntebe Ayo William (Tatale-Sanguli):** To make a Statement on the poor demarcation of electoral boundaries and overcrowded polling stations as root causes of election disputes in Ghana.

Questions

Q.377. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan):
To ask the Minister for Roads and

Highways when work will commence on the following areas in the Kadjebi District, since the Feeder Department completed the survey and mapping years ago: (i) Dodi-Papase to Dodo-Pepesu (ii) Dodo-Amanfrom to Daapa Junction (iii) Asato to Wawaso (iv) Koto-Nkwanta to Titiaka (v) Koto-Nkwanta to Sabram

Q.453. Mr Yao Gomado (Akan) To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the following roads will be fixed: (i) Dodo – Olobi to Okrakrom (Koru) (ii) Akposokodzi Township Kadjebi road.

Q.455. Mr Sanja Nanja (Atebubu/Amantin): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways what immediate measures the Ministry is implementing to fix the potholes on the Amantin and the Yeji stretch of the Kumasi-Yeji Highway to prevent further deterioration of the road.

Q.380. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the government is going to renovate the Sogakope Bridge (Lower Volta Bridge), especially the expansion gaps and the metal railings.

Q.381. Mr Maxwell Kwame Lukutor (South Tongu): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of work on the Agave-Afedume Road and when work will commence on site.

Q.476. Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the current state of the

Ejisu-Onwe-Assieninpong-Kwaso road in the Ejisu Constituency and when work will resume to complete the road.

Q.512.Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will be resumed and completed (i) Maakro – Agogo- Twedie (ii) Supreme Saviour – Canaan.

Q.516. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following abandoned roads will be resumed and completed: (i) Bosankro Junction – Bosankro (ii) Akuapim Junction – Akuapim.

Q.517. Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction works will resume on the following roads: (i) Wiosu – Amanchia (ii) Nkawie – Nkran Foase (iii) Ntabanum Junction – Ntabanum.

Q.515. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central): To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the contractor for the Community 9 Light Industrial Area Road network will return to site.

Motions

Committee Sitings

Thursday, 12th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

(a) **Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo):** To make a Statement on the need to prioritise the completion and optimal utilisation of existing Sports Infrastructure before initiating New Projects.

(b) **Mr Eric Edem Agbana (Ketu North):** To make a Statement on the need to upgrade the Ohawu Agricultural College into a fully-fledged Agricultural University.

(c) **Mr Sebastian Deh (Kpando):** To make a Statement on supporting Smallholder Farmers in Ghana- The role of financial inclusion with tailor-made Innovative Financial Products.

Questions

Q.542. Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu): To ask the Minister for Transport the progress of work on the Boankra Inland Port in the Ejisu Constituency.

Q.632. Nana Ampaw Kwame Addo-Frempong (Abuakwa North): To ask the Minister for Transport the total number of permanent staff and contract staff at the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority (DVLA) as of 7th January, 2025 and at the end of September, 2025.

Q.639. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso): To ask the Minister for Transport the measures the Ministry has put in place to ensure the airworthiness

of our domestic commercial aircraft and the safety of the crew and passengers.

Q.658. Nana Ampaw Kwame Addo-Frempong (Abuakwa North): To ask the Minister for Transport the number of Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority offices across the country as at 7th January, 2025 and at the end of September 2025.

Q.535. Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri): To ask the Minister of State in Charge of Government Communications the full details of the Government Advisory Council which was set up upon the invitation of the President to representatives of Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) in Ghana, and what this auxiliary body is costing the taxpayer.

Q.96. Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (Old Tafo): To ask the Minister of State in charge of Government Communication the total cost of all committees formed by the President and Ministers and the sources of funds since the expenditure was not included in the first-quarter budget approved by Parliament.

Q.112. Mr Pious Kwame Nkuah (Sefwi-Akontombra): To ask the Minister for Health why the Sefwi Akontombra District Hospital, which was initially proposed to be 46-bed capacity, was reduced to 26-bed capacity after completion.

Q.151. Dr Kingsley Agyemang (Abuakwa South): To ask the Minister for Health how the Ministry works with

community health care providers and civil society to roll out overdose response training, public education and psychosocial support as part of the national response to opioid abuse.

Q.152. Dr Kingsley Agyemang (Abuakwa South): To ask the Minister for Health what concrete steps the Ministry is taking to ensure timely reimbursement to health service providers under NHIS to prevent future disruptions that directly impact vulnerable citizens.

Q.250. Ms Mavis Kuukua Bissie (Ahanta West): To ask the Minister for Health the current status of the Agenda 111 hospital project at Bokoro in the Ahanta West Constituency which was commissioned in an uncompleted state by former President Nana Adoo Dankwa Akkufo-Addo and when is it expected to be fully completed and operational.

Q.264. Mr Emmanuel K. Ntekuni (Pru West): To ask the Minister for Health the plans of the Ministry to replace the damaged ambulance of Pru West Constituency which was involved in an accident on 27th September, 2024.

Q.325. Mr Sulemana Alhassan (Yunyoo): To ask the Minister for Health to provide an update on the status of the Agenda 111 hospital project in Yunyoo/Nasuan District and when the District can expect the hospital to be operational, thereby improving access to quality healthcare service for residents.

Q.396. Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (Suhum): To ask the Minister for Health the plans of the Ministry to construct an

accident and emergency wing in the Suhum Municipal Government Hospital to serve numerous accident victims on the Accra-Kumasi highway.

Q.491. Prof Kingsley Nyarko (Kwadaso): To ask the Minister for Health what mitigating measures the Ministry has implemented or considering to implement to prevent staff of the National Health Insurance Authority from being removed from their office as was witnessed at the Kwabre East.

Q.511. Mr Martin Adjei-Mensah Korsah (Techiman South): To ask the Minister for Health when the construction work on the proposed Bono East Regional Hospital would commence.

Q.553. Mr Alexander Akwasi Acquah (Akim Oda): To ask the Minister for Health an update on the plans to regulate and professionalise traditional medicine practices and integrate them into the national health framework.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

(#) Second Reading of Bills

- Intestate Succession Bill, 2025.
- Governance Advisory Council Bill, 2025.

Committee Sitings

Friday, 13th February, 2026

Roll Call

Statements

(a) **Mr Kwabena Boateng (Ejisu):** To make a Statement on the deplorable condition of roads in the Ejisu Constituency.

(b) **Mr Bismark Tetteh Nyarko (Upper Manya Krobo):** To make a Statement on the Overflow of River Klum on the Asesewa- Abuorso road and its impact on commuters.

(c) **Mr Emmanuel Tobbin (Anyaa Sowutuom):** To make a Statement on Broken Traffic Lights and Pedestrian Safety in Ghana.

Urgent Question

(#) **Ms Shirley Kyei (Atwima Nwabiagya South):** To ask the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology how the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) intend to scale up the marketing and distribution of its newly introduced food products and to support food security and small Agro-Processors.

Questions

Q.501. Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri): To ask the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology the extent of enforcement

and adherence to the bilateral agreement between Ghana and Singapore pursuant to Article 6 of the Paris Agreement and what benefits we can boast of today since it is coming into force.

Q.502. Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh (Nsawam-Adoagyiri): To ask the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology how many Ghanaians the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) has employed in the past 3 months, the categories of officers employed, and if financial clearance was obtained from the Ministry of Finance for such employment within the period mentioned.

Q.282. Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South): To ask the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology the measures the Ministry is taking to ensure that important research findings from the various research institutions do not go to waste.

Q.283 Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku (Offinso South): To ask the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology the measures the Ministry is implementing to protect the coastal and marine environment from plastic pollution.

Q.334. Ms Gloria Owusu (Trobu): To ask the Minister for Environment, Science and Technology the timelines and expected amendments in the review of the Biosafety Act, 2021 (Act 831) in 2025 and how the review will incorporate new global biosecurity standards.

Q.335. Mr Elvis Osei Mensah Dapaah (Ahafo Ano South West): To ask the Minister Environment, Science and Technology what mechanisms have been taken by the Ghana Atomic Energy Commission (GAEC) to monitor the adoption and use of the 6,000 disease-free plantain plantlets and BSF-based Technologies among farmers.

Q.367. Rev John Ntim Fordjour (Assin South): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the measures the Ministry is implementing to prevent the desecration of the Independence Arch, Kwame Nkrumah Mausoleum and other sacred national monuments by same-sex couples and LGBTQ+ activists.

Q.544. Mr Lawrence Agyinsam (Hemang Lower Denkyira): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the plans of the Ministry to expand employment to the indigenes in Kakum National Park enclave who have been marginalised from employment opportunities in the Constituency.

Q.577. Mr Charles Forson (Tema Central): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts how the Ministry plans to implement the Black Star experience in 2025 and what institutional partnerships and private sector collaborations are being established to ensure its success as a diaspora tourism brand.

Q.595. Mr Felix Akwetey Okle (Bortianor Ngleshie Amanfro): To ask the Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts the plans of the Ministry to

develop the Solo Monkey Forest in Bortianor to expand the tourism industry for economic development and sustainable ecological management.

Q.649. Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (Evalue-Ajomoro Gwira): To ask the Minister for Sports and Recreation when the all-important Youth Resource Centre in Axim will be completed and officially commissioned for public use.

Presentation of Papers

Motions

Committee Sitings

2:38 p.m.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Business Statement ably presented by the Chairman of the Business Committee. I will then open the floor for comments on the Business Statement.

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Mr Speaker, with respect, I would want to draw the attention of the Majority Leader to a very important issue. On 20th January, 2026, the Minority Leader, the Deputy Minority Leader, and my good self, made an application to the Speaker of Parliament, which application was in respect to a Half-Hour Motion to investigate into how and why, in the teacher manuals that have been given to

teachers across the country, there are tendencies of Lesbians, Gays, Bisexual, Transgender, Queer (LGBTQ+) in there. Per the Motion that was submitted to the Speaker of Parliament, he referred the said application to the Committee on Education.

Mr Speaker, I am very much aware that the Business Committee's attention was drawn to this effect, and we were expecting that at least it will find expression into the Business Committee's Statement that the Committee on Education would have to investigate into why teacher manuals and curriculum for our basic schools and senior high schools had the tendencies of LGBTQ+ in there. So, if the Majority Leader, with respect, would want to comment on that, because as we speak, I know that the Majority Leader himself, at least per conduct, is not interested in bringing this matter to the Floor. The only voice of conscience that is left is the Speaker of Parliament, and I hope that that will not be lost on us.

Thank you very much.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, to start from where my Colleague ended, I think yesterday —[*Interruption*—]he ended somewhere, and that has to do with the LGBTQ+ in our curriculum.

Mr Speaker, yesterday I was at the Business Committee meeting, but fortunately or unfortunately, the Majority Leader, who is the Chairman of the Business Committee, was not available at the Committee meeting. We

did discuss, among other things, even the Bill itself, the LGBTQ+. [Laughter]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, what did you say the name of the Bill was?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am talking about lesbians, gays, bisexual, transgender, queers. Do you know the meaning of the Q?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, with all due respect, are you talking about the Promotion of Proper Human Sexual Rights and Ghanaian Family Values Bill?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, it is so strange that some people are now marrying trees, and it is part of those alphabets that have been abbreviated. I am saying that people are saying trees are their spouse. My issue here is that the Bill is missing.

Mr Speaker, the Committee you chair appeared before you, but we were told that it will still find its way into our *Order Paper*. Until now, nothing is happening. Yesterday, the Majority Chief Whip, who chaired the Business Committee, directed the Clerk to include—I do not mean the Clerk-to-Parliament but the Clerk to the Business Committee. The Clerk-to-Parliament was not present at that meeting but Mr Camilo Pwamang, the Deputy Clerk was there yesterday. The Majority Chief Whip said they should capture that on the *Order Paper* but it is missing again. I do not know whether Mr Camilo Pwamang

deliberately refused to add the LGBTQ+. And on a more serious note —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, on a more serious note, we do not have such Bills ever passing through the House. The Bill has an appropriate title and that is what I want you to mention. I have even started drawing your attention. Are you talking about the Promotion of Proper Human Sexual Rights and Ghanaian Family Values Bill or are you talking about a different thing?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, in this Chamber, some Members mention MahamaCares, but we do not have MahamaCares and we have passed a Bill to that effect. People are on this Floor saying that we are passing MahamaCares but there is nothing like MahamaCares.

Mr Speaker, let me make my point —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you are also agreeing that there is nothing like LGBTQ+.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am talking about Promotion of Proper Human Sexual Rights and Ghanaian Family Values Bill. [Hear! Hear!]

I do not know if the Majority Leader can schedule either the Northern Regional Minister or the Minister for Education. There are these fire incidents recently happening in senior high schools in the Northern Region and it always affects the girls' dormitory. So

far, three secondary schools, Northern School of Business, Kpong Tamale Senior High School and my own backyard, the Tolon Senior High School girls' dormitories caught fire. I do not know whether it is within the territory of the Northern Regional Minister or the Minister for Education so that we can —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, is it not the case that you know what to do per the rules?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, not to file a Question, because Questions may not generally be able to answer everything that is contained because of these fire issues. It may be more to what the Question may answer. That is why —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Questions are not the only tool available for you under the Standing Orders.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, what I am discussing here was discussed at the Business Committee. I raised it and the Chairman said either the Minister for Education or the Regional Minister can be scheduled so that they can brief the House. Those who were at the Business Committee meeting will bear me out that I discussed it there, that something urgent needs to be done. Because at the moment, I do not know how to describe it, that it happens in just the girls' dormitories in these senior high schools.

If we can have either the Minister for Education or the Regional Minister to brief us and tell us measures that they will put to make sure that this does not happen again. In Tolon Senior High School, in 2023-2024, there was a similar issue and I had to step in. But about two weeks ago, there was fire again.

Mr Speaker, that is the reason I am bringing this matter, so that the Chairman of the Business Committee can get the appropriate institution to address us on this issue. More may be coming because when it started from Northern School of Business, we thought that was it then it moved to Tolon Senior High. We thought that was it, then it moved it from Tamale Senior High School. Definitely, we need a proper briefing, then we will be able to see how we can help to stop this issue.

2:48 p.m.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: I thank you, Mr Speaker.

Let me thank the Leader of the House for the Statement he just delivered to the House. I am also happy about the guidelines on how to make Statements.

Mr Speaker, we made a lot of Statements, and most times, we do not see the end use of those Statements. At times, useful Statements are referred to certain appropriate Committees, but we do not get the outcome of the Committee's final work on those

Statements. So, I will plead with the Leader that it should not be Business as usual. We need to get some benefits from the Statements, not only just reading them. When Statements are referred to Committees, we expect the Committees to get back to us or to the appropriate ministry so that we can act on them for the benefit of our society.

Mr Speaker, the second issue has to do with—I remember during the last Meeting, I made a request to the Leader and the Clerk to Parliament that if we look on our console, the principal documents we need for our work are captured. We have the Standing Orders there, the National Pledge, but the 1992 Constitution is not found here. I made a request that, if possible, we could also have the 1992 Constitution on it for ease of reference. Even though we come to the Chamber with the Standing Orders and the 1992 Constitution, since the Standing Orders are already on the console, let us also have the 1992 Constitution on it.

Thank you.

Mr Maxwell K. Lukutor: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Let me also use this opportunity to thank the Leader for the Business Statement, and wish you a happy birthday. Being a neighbour, I think it is right in place to wish you. We were just in your office, eating *yake yake* and *abobi tadi*.

Mr Speaker, on the Business Statement, the guidelines as stipulated by the Leader on Statements, I thought that at one point we were restricted to only

two pages, or not more than three pages. Seeing 15 minutes to be used for making Statements will make the pages more than two. So, I think that restricting to two pages would have been better than giving 15 minutes. To read for 15 minutes is more than being restricted to two pages. That is what I would want us to look at, rather, and if we are going to be restricted to the pages and the font size 12 or 14, then we are all guided by the number of pages we need to produce. That would be better than the 15 minutes, which would be more than the two pages that we are restricted to.

On that note, I thank the Leader for the Business Statement.

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. Let me also join my Hon Colleagues in thanking the Leader of the House for the Statement of Business for the ensuing week. Mr Speaker, I would want to add my voice to the fact that 15 minutes is just optimal for a Statement, and we have to translate that to the number of pages. We should not limit it to two pages, and try to work backwards to determine the time. The reason I say this is that we have had to go back and forth with Mr Speaker on some Statements that some of us wanted to make, and in fact, religiously going by rules, I know that if it is two pages, you would insist that it must be two pages. But when we work backwards and the time is given, everyone can manage their time and be able to select salient points to present on his Statement.

So, I agree with the proposal by the Leader of the House that 15 minutes

should be 15 minutes, and it is alright, within which we can make our submission if there is any Statement to be made by a Member of this House.

Mr Speaker, there is another issue; I do not know how this House treats it. A Statement was admitted in the last meeting of this particular House. Those Statements were never read because of time, but for these two weeks, we have not seen them advertised. And I think that we should rather be trying to address the arrears of Statement.

I remember I had a Statement that was advertised in the *Order Paper*, but because of the time and the want of space in the last sitting of considering the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, I was not able to take the Statement. But two weeks down the line, even with the advertised Statement, I have not seen it. So, I want to get direction on whether or not we treat the backlog before we admit new ones. If we do, how come that Statement did not find expression in this particular week or the Business for the ensuing week?

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Nana Asafo Adjei Ayeh: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I also want to wish you a happy birthday. Let me first and foremost commend the Business Committee, the Majority Leader, and his team, for the work they have done. A lot of the points I want to raise, particularly with Statements have been made, so I

would not belabour the point, except to add that Order 93 is clear.

Mr Speaker, to adhere to all the guidelines that have been given by the Business Committee and the Majority Leader, a lot will behove on the Speaker and the Speaker's Secretariat, so that they would help us to go strictly according to the requirements and the regulations on the timelines that have been set out. This is because it lies in the bosom of the Speaker to make modifications to whatever Statement, or the font size, *et cetera*. Mr Speaker, some of the times when Statements are read on the Floor, we sit down, and you get tired. It is as if a whole thesis is being read. There is a procedure for which the Standing Order provides which it goes through for the Speaker must go through to admit. The assumption is that this Statement was admitted by the Speaker to be read on the Floor.

Mr Speaker, inasmuch as Members are guided, I would plead on the indulgence of the Speaker to also ensure that some of these guidelines are adhered to from their outlet, so that Members on the Floor will be guided as such.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me join Hon Colleagues to wish you well on this auspicious day. We can disagree with you on a number of occasions, but one cannot help but appreciate your appreciation of the rules, procedure, and things many people do not know which is that your sense of humour is legendary.

3:00 p.m.

Mr Speaker, let me start off from page 2, item number 3, referrals at Committees. If the Hon Majority Leader would recall, I think we all lamented on the backlog of referrals, and the conclusion was not to issue the usual appeals. If the Hon Majority Leader would remember, he said that we put out some punitive measures against Chairpersons of Committees who are not working on the referrals, but I see a repeat of an appeal. I do not know if that is supposed to be the new state of affairs.

Mr Speaker, I want to commend the Hon Majority Leader because I see a good attempt to increase the number of Questions to be taken for the ensuing week, 50 Questions. Earlier, the proposed number of Questions, if the Hon Majority Chief Whip would remember, was around 30 or 40—[**Mr Dafeamekpor:** 45]—Yes, then he said that we should push it. Now it is 50. But it is still not enough. I think we can do more because on relative terms—Mr Speaker, I commend Majority Leadership that 50 Questions is a good attempt. But because of the backlog of over 300 Questions. So, let us try, because we have done an average of 70 Questions before. So, let us see if we can shoot it up to 60 Questions, because if we are not careful, some of the Questions will be overtaken by events, and may not be useful again. That would be my first observation.

Mr Speaker, I am being fair here. The Hon Majority Leader was not present, so the Hon Majority Chief Whip stood in

his stead and presided over the Business Committee meeting. Maybe the Hon Majority Leader has not been properly briefed. There was an agreement at the Committee that three Ministers be scheduled to come and brief the House. The Hon Majority Chief Whip is here. If I am wrong, he should tell me. The Clerk is here. The Minister for Foreign Affairs, the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, and the Minister of State responsible for Climate and Sustainability, all of them were to be scheduled by an agreement of the Committee that they should come and brief the House. I can see the unseen hand operation of the Majority Leader. I know his hands very well. His hands are operating. None of the three Ministers can be found on the Business Statement. Why? It was a decision of the Committee. Ministers for Foreign Affairs, Climate and Sustainability, and Lands and Natural Resources, because of the *galamsey*, which they are not too comfortable to hear, but they are not here.

Mr Speaker, if we should reference Order 216 of our Standing Orders, it is not in the hands of the Hon Majority Leader. We know his operations, and we respect him, but he cannot, *suo moto*, vary a decision of the Committee. I submit strongly that what he has presented is not a true reflection of the meeting we held. It cannot be. So, I beg of the Hon Majority Leader, this one is not within his power to vary. This one, we will not agree. He varied it. I expect you to support him. So, we should take a look at that.

Mr Speaker, the outstanding formulas for the District Assemblies Common Fund (DACF), Ghana Education Trust Fund (GETFund), and correct me if I am wrong, I think even National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) is also outstanding. Nothing has been mentioned of the formulas. I am aware of a few concerns by the Leader of the House, but we need to put finality to it because payments to the assemblies—Yes, the Minister for Finance was in this House when he presented the last Budget. And he had indicated that 80 per cent of District Assemblies Common Fund will go to the assemblies. We support that. If we do not pass the formulas early enough, the funds cannot be transferred. And, Mr Speaker, we have the constitutional mandate to pass the formulas. No show. And they have told us 24-Hour Economy. We are yet to pass the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, and they have told us with all seriousness that, that is going to happen. So, the Hon Majority Leader should take good notice.

Again, Mr Speaker, cost of living is going through the roof. Mr Speaker, I should have come with some food items: yam, tomatoes, gari and plantain. The prices have gone through the roof. We should be programming the Exchequer to come and tell us measures. The last time, before the Budget was brought here, he was gallivanting at Makola, talking to the Makola women. He should be going to Makola now and checking the price of tomatoes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, kindly comment

on the Business Statement. Your comment should be on the Business Statement, not on the Finance and Economic Policy.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Ghanaians are watching them. Before the Budget, the Minister was all over Agbogbloshie and Makola, talking to the women. Prices of tomatoes, yam, cocoyam, cassava have gone through the roof. Are they proud of the price of cocoyam now? Mr Speaker, I want to plead with the Leader of the House. It will not be out of place if we programme our Friend—It is not for nothing that the Minister for Finance is one of our own. He should come and tell us measures that could be put in place—We are the people's representatives. We are the only people who can talk about this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, you have started framing a nice question. That would have been good.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: We will make your birthday celebration a memorable one. I want to assure you. We in the Minority will make your birthday celebration today a memorable one.

Mr Speaker, if I may conclude. Yesterday, the Leader of the House appealed to us when we came under Order 64 and Article 102 to abandon the application, and we did. I see his new tactics. He has moved all his Members to one side so that the public and the cameras can focus on them and say that the numbers are more. Look this way; they have been exposed. [*Uproar*] Mr

Speaker, I can see the Hon Majority Chief Whip has rehearsed his tactics, but it is not good enough.

So, Mr Speaker, we want to appeal to the Hon Majority Leader that cost of living is becoming too high, and they have come on the back of the promise to reset our country. I am only reminding them of their own messages on the reset agenda. Cost of living is supposed to come down. Mr Speaker, the last time I went to Agbogloboshie, the market women were complaining; teachers are complaining; doctors are complaining; local farmers are complaining; footballers are complaining. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, I think you have indicated that today we want to do light Business, and on that note, I have a lot of items I want to speak to but I want to respect the Leader of the House since the agreement is that we will prosecute light Business since today is Friday. But I have given them heads up on the issues we expect them to function on. *[Interruption]* Who? I will not mind you.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, I think, is a Private Member's Bill. So, when a private Member decides to introduce a bill,

3:08 p.m.

I think it is for us to engage with the Office of the Speaker; if there are issues, iron out those issues, and then get all clearances for it to be admitted. It is not Government Business. We have indicated that, so far as we are concerned, the Bill was passed. What was outstanding was for the President to sign, and the former President did not sign. It came back, and the Government said it was willing to take it and own it as a Government Bill, but that was rejected because the private Members want to own it instead of the Government taking it and then presenting it as a Government Bill.

Since they have indicated they want to own and push it, they know the various processes involved. We will continue to say that we, on this Side, have no issue with anything in the Bill, and the President has indicated that he is waiting 24 hours. If the Bill is ready, he will sign it. We do not have a problem, so they should work it out with the Office of the Speaker.

Yes, we have reports of fires in schools, and I know that the Minister for Education had even indicated that the Government had directed that, allocations be made to those schools for the construction of the hostels and the facilities that they will need. So, work has been done to address that problem, but they can ask a Question and the Minister can come and answer it.

I also agree that 15 minutes may be too long for Statement time, but that is what the Committee agreed to. So, let us live with that for now. Regarding the scheduling of Ministers, when I received the draft report, I reached out, but it is unlikely the Ministers will be in town on those dates. In all sincerity, the Ministers are not likely to be in town on those dates. I thought it would be better to engage them and ensure they come while they are in town. In any case, if they are available—if we look at the Statement time, I indicated that Statements by Ministers can be made anytime during the week. We can make provision for the Ministers to come.

As for the issue of the cost of living which the Hon Member raised, I do not know which market he goes to, but I know that because of the low rate of inflation, because of the very good exchange rate relationship between the cedi and the dollar, because of the stability of the cedi and so many other good things that this Government has done, definitely prices of goods and services cannot be going up. In fact, we are dealing with the problem of farmers saying that food prices have come so low that they cannot even recover their investments in farming.

So it is inconceivable that farmers would be complaining that prices are so low for their food, and he is here in this Chamber complaining about the cost of living. But I understand: if one is in the habit of driving very expensive cars such

as Maybachs and Rolls-Royces, the prices of spare parts and servicing for those vehicles can be very high. But as for the cost of living for ordinary Ghanaians who eat *kenkey*, *konkonte* and fish, *et cetera*, I think that they know that the prices of food have not increased. If anything, it is decreasing, and the cost of living is not a major issue in this economy. I agree with them that there are many issues we should address, and we will work on them, but the cost of living is definitely not—Fuel prices are coming down, which is a major trigger when it comes to the cost of foodstuffs and services.

There is so much stability in the Energy sector, so generally, the outlook is very good. Ghanaians are very hopeful; we are very confident.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, today is Friday. I think I am inclined, after taking the Leader, to draw the curtains down. So, the Business Statement as presented is accordingly adopted.

Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: I know that it is for the Majority Leader to ask for the next step, but Mr Speaker, there is one thing I have observed in this Chamber: we have paid a lot of attention to people who are dead and gone. We come, and we do our tributes.

I also believe fervently that, today being your birthday, you should just spare me a minute or two. I have jotted something down with my colleagues at Keta Senior High Technical School (KETASCO) to let you know that we cherish and love you. If you would not mind, I know this is a difficult task for you, and this is more of a trap. If you would not mind, you should admit this Statement, since it is just a minute. It is not a bad Statement; it is just a birthday wish.

Mr Speaker, if you would not mind, let me start. *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister pleaded with me for us to vary the order of Business to take the Third Reading of the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 so that we can move to the Second Consideration Stage. After that, we can do the Statements. The major Business would have been done for the day; then we can make the Statements.

I am not against the Statements being made, but let us just take out this 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know if the Majority Leader was saying Third Reading of the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025. Yesterday, clause 24 was referred to the

Winnowing Committee. So, we have to go back to the Consideration Stage before the Third Reading, right? So, I do not know.

Mr Ayariga: The procedure is that we attempt to do Third Reading, and then it will be arrested, and then a Second Consideration will take place. It was passed, was it not?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, no, the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 was at the Consideration Stage. We stopped at the Consideration Stage because two clauses were deferred. So, what we can do now is to bring it back to a Consideration Stage.

So, Hon Members, the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 at the Consideration Stage.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025

Resumption of Consideration Stage from 5/02/2026

3:18 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we deferred clause 7, and we also deferred clause 24, which are likely to have an impact on clause 12.

So, Hon Members, we then go to clause 7.

Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

[Pause]

Please, I think I am right on this occasion. We could not put the Question on clause 7(4).

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, you are right. What you are saying is that we concluded on clause 12, but clause 24 may have an effect on clause 12. So, if we bring the report on clause 24, then we will be guided by clause 12. But with clause 7 and clause 24, there was no Question put on these two clauses. Therefore, clause 7 and clause 24 were both deferred.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Chairman of the Committee, what is the position on clause 7(4)?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, on clause 7(4), I think the consensus was that we maintain the status quo.

Mr Speaker, I read it again:

“A member of the Board, other than the Chief Executive Officer, who is absent from three consecutive meetings of the Board without sufficient cause, ceases to be a member of the Board.”

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Members, on that note, I will put the Question on the entire clause 7.

Yes, Hon Dr Kabiru?

Dr. A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, clause 7 was deferred basically because of its current rendition. The rendition that the Chairman of the Committee is proposing to have, and I even remember yesterday that reference was made to other Acts or Bills that we have passed, that provision, which exempts the Chief Executive Officer, was not part of it, and that was the reason we deferred it.

Mr Speaker, I think that the Chairman of the Committee insisted that we should exempt the Chief Executive Officer from being part of meetings, or he could exempt himself or absent himself from three consecutive meetings of the Board without a just cause or without authorisation. It is not, with the greatest of respect, something that this House should accept. I do not know the reasons, maybe he would want to explain to us the further engagement he made to come to the conclusion that the current rendition should stay.

Mr Speaker, without that explanation, how do we call on the House to vote on the same matter when consensus was built that further engagement should be done? With the engagement that was done, the reason for letting it stand as it is should be explained to us before he can carry us along.

So, the Chairman of the Committee would have to explain why we need to accept the rendition as it stands now.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I am just going to repeat exactly what I said yesterday. That the Chief Executive Officer reports to the Board. The Chief Executive Officer is a member of the Board. Unless and until the Chief Executive Officer's position is taken, it is not the number of times that he has attended or not attended Board meetings that would take him off that duty. He is the Chief Executive Officer representing the institution. So, whether three, four, or five consecutive times, he remains the Chief Executive Officer.

So, Mr Speaker, I think we have belaboured this point for far too long. I think you should put the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon John Darko?

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, yesterday, I think the Hon Leader of the House and my own Friend, Hon Dafeamekpor, actually agreed with us that the Chief Executive position is so important that the Chief Executive should not be allowed to absent himself for three consecutive times without just cause or authorisation. So, the agreement was for us to defer this provision for further engagement. But for some of the committees to come back to say that the status quo should remain, then it is as if

all the arguments we made yesterday came to naught.

Mr Speaker, we had a very genuine reason. We are dealing with a 24-Hour Economy Authority, and the Chief Executive of that Authority can choose to absent himself without giving reasons for three consecutive meetings, and there will be no consequence. We believe that we need to understand that this is no joke. At least, the person should be made to give a reason for absenting himself. This was the case we made yesterday, and nothing has changed. The Chairman of the Committee has not engaged anybody, and then he comes back to say that the status quo should remain. I think that we should do better engagement on this.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Darko-Mensah: Mr Speaker, I believe that this is purely a governance issue. The Chief Executive cannot be allowed to absent himself, and us to think that everything is well with the Board. If the Chief Executive is particularly absent three times for not attending a board meeting, naturally, there might be something wrong. So, I believe that we might have to engage properly and make sure that either we exempt the Chief Executive from the other members of the Board, or there should be a reason attached to his absence. Because it is going to be very weird for the Board to have three board meetings without the operator, who is the Chief Executive,

being present. If we are not careful, and we have a Board Chairman who has problems with the Chief Executive, he can easily conspire with other people and have three board meetings without the Chief Executive which would actually lead to his sacking.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Exactly.

Mr Darko-Mensah: So, we have to be clear with what we want to achieve with this particular provision. The Chief Executive is the operator, and he has to be present virtually at every board meeting, unless maybe he has travelled, or is sick, and the Board needs to make a decision for itself.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, that is exactly the point that we are making. It is because they want to avoid those instances, and the fact that the Chief Executive is there by virtue of being the Chief Executive of the institution, the appointing authority is different. So, there may be a situation where the Chief Executive has absented himself three times, and by this law, we are saying he is not supposed to be a member of the Board. But the appointing authority can decide to keep him as the Chief Executive. So, it means that there will be a board meeting without the Chief Executive. That is the reason for which we have to maintain the rendition the way it is.

So, if, after consultation, the Chairman came to a conclusion, just like

the way you are saying, that the rendition should be allowed to stay, I believe that we have to take it in good faith and make progress.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, they are asking for reasons, but I support the Chairperson in all due respect. The Chief Executive could be engaged in other equally important activities, and that should not prevent the Board from operating. So, it would be strange to sack the Chief Executive because they have absented themselves for more than three consecutive times. So, I support the fact that we should exclude the Chief Executive and let the current rendition be maintained. I do not think a Chief Executive would deliberately absent themselves from a board meeting.

So, the current rendition for me should stand.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Ayariga: I think it is important that the point that Mr Speaker has made should be understood. For a Board to function well and to make decisions, we usually need the support of the Chief Executive.

3:28 p.m.

It is usually the only reason it is made automatic that the Chief Executive Officer should be a member of the board for harmonious working relationship. If

we introduce a clause that says if the Chief Executive Officer is absent three times, he is dismissed and ceases to be a member of the board, but he is still the Chief Executive Officer, how are they as a board going to function effectively without the Chief Executive sitting in the meeting and guiding them? The person who is going to execute the decision of the board is the Chief Executive Officer. If we push the Chief Executive Officer out because they did not attend three meetings, the board will suffer because the board is not the same as the office of the Chief Executive Officer. Once we are not dismissing him as a Chief Executive Officer and we are saying they should not be a member of the board, there will be problem. I think that practically we have never had a situation where there has been a move to remove a Chief Executive Officer because he did not attend meetings. Let us live with this rendition because administratively, it is fine. The alternative is equally good but there is nothing wrong with this rendition. So, let us make progress. Let us live with this one and then make progress.

Clause 7 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 24 — Annual report and other reports

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, upon some consultations as referred by the Speaker, we have made some consultations and have come out with the

following rendition for clause 24. We propose to *delete* in line 3, “responsible for finance”. The new rendition will read:

“The Board shall, within 30 days after the receipt of the audit report, submit an annual report to the President and the Minister covering the activities of the operations of the Authority for the year to which the report relates.”

I so move, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I just want to get clarification from the Chairperson. The Chairperson said upon further consultation. Is it consultation or the Winnowing Committee met and decided on it? This is because Mr Speaker referred this to the Winnowing Committee, not for consultation. I want to get that straight. Whether the new rendition is coming from the Winnowing Committee or—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, the previous day when we got to this particular clause, there was the need to seek clarity with the sponsors of the Bill. That was indicated clearly on the Floor. So, if the Chairperson of the Committee is talking about consultation, it is consultation with the sponsors of the Bill as indicated.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, and the Winnowing Committee.

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: I need a bit of clarity, because clause 24 was tied to clause 12 yesterday when we had this discussion. Clause 12(2) says the President may write and designate a Minister. The proposed rendition that I proposed was Minister designate. But in his proposal, he said Minister. Is that by that to suggest that consequentially we will have a definition of Minister in this, because it will not be consistent with—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Exactly so.

There will be definition of a Minister, and a Minister will mean Minister designate by the President. The word “Minister” takes care of the situation.

So, I will put a question.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, just a quick one. It looked like yesterday if I heard the Chairperson right, he said “Minister” should be deleted from the interpretation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I asked that “Minister” should not be deleted pending this consultation.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr S. Mahama Mr Speaker, consequentially, under clause 24 (3) and (4), we will *delete* “responsible for finance” in both subclauses.

Clause 24(3) will read:

“The Minister shall, within 30 days after the receipt of the annual report, submit a report to Parliament with a statement that the Minister considers necessary.”

Clause 24(4) will now read:

“The Board shall submit to the Minister any other report which the Minister may require in writing.”

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, this is a consequential amendment.

Question put and amendments agreed to.

Clause 24 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairperson of the Committee, the impact on clause 12.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, having amended clause 24, it would definitely have an impact on clause 12. We move to clause 12(2); we would *delete* “any other person”.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, yesterday we were seeking guidance from Mr Speaker with regards to the same clause 12. Mr Speaker said we have passed clause 12, and if we have to do any amendment to clause 12, we have to come under Second Consideration. Mr Speaker, I do not know why you would give him that opportunity to do an amendment to a clause that we have voted on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. At the conclusion of the day, we indicated, and the record will bear us out, that the amendment to clause 24 will have impacts on clause 12. That is why when clause 24 was amended, I am asking the Chairman what then is the impact on clause 12. The impact is what the Chairman is indicating, and that is for the Consideration of the House.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, at the point that we were making proposals to amendment in clause 24, we did indicate that it would definitely have an effect on clause 12, and we were proposing an amendment to it. But Mr Speaker said we cannot. When we pass the clause, that is not the practice, they can come back at the Second Consideration, just make amendment to that clause, and we will carry on. Other than that, Mr Speaker, this is too alien to the practice of this House that we have passed through a clause, put a vote on that clause, and we do not come back at Second Consideration only to come back to it. Mr Speaker, I do not know.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, do you know why at Consideration Stage the rules are relaxed? Do you know why the Mace is tilted? So Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, clearly, we need to understand the rudiment of the game that certain things are at the discretion of the Speaker.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I respect that very well. Mr Speaker, when you do this, you are putting us in a very tight corner. This is because people are learning the process of lawmaking, and people know that at Consideration Stage, when we pass a vote on a clause, we cannot visit it again until Second Consideration.

Mr Speaker, if you are relaxed — because people are learning the lawmaking process, and we are taking guidance from you. Yesterday on the same clause, I raised that—

3:38 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, it is about time people realised that certain things are at the discretion of the Speaker. Therefore, if we passed clause 12, and we are at clause 20, and you want to bring me back to clause 12, you would even know what to do in the circumstances. It can only be done by the leave of the Speaker.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, today is your birthday, but strongly, this is not the practice of this House; it has never happened that way. If you are introducing it, fine. Today is your

birthday, so let us make progress. We are celebrating you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I have been in this House, and have been fully involved in the passage of the law. When you do it properly, the Speaker may give you the opportunity, that is, if you say, “Mr Speaker, even though we have passed clause 12, by your leave, can I take you back to clause 12?” The Speaker will decide to grant you the leave or not. But in the circumstances, the House has agreed that we need to consider clause 24, and the consideration of clause 24 would have impact on clause 12. Therefore, automatically, once clause 24 is amended, it will have a consequential impact on clause 12.

So, in that case, if the person presiding is asking the Chairman of the Committee, what then is the impact, it does not derogate from our rules. So, Chairman of the Committee, what is the impact?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, yesterday we all knew that it would have an impact. But we agreed that we would take it during the Second Consideration Stage. If we check our *Hansard*, yesterday we agreed. Even this afternoon, when he raised it, I told him that we took the clause yesterday, so we will take it during Second Consideration Stage. That was why I asked him to hold on, when we get to the Third Reading, he should arrest the process so that we will revisit that clause. It is not a complicated exercise. We are already at the Third Reading.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I believe what you said was in reference to clauses 7 and 24, which has been corrected.

Mr Ayariga: No, clause 12.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But I have no position when it comes to this. Then let us go to the Interpretation Clause. I asked that they should hold on with the meaning of “Minister” as contained in the Interpretation.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, that impact transcends not only clause 12 but to the Interpretation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, but yesterday there was a proposal in the *Order Paper* to delete the interpretation given to “Minister”. I ask that we should stop, and not move that amendment at that material moment. So, we did not move the amendment and no decision was taken on it, that is why we are revisiting it still at the Consideration Stage.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I will not delete it as we discussed yesterday. So, “Minister” will remain as “means the Minister referred to in subsection (2) of section 12”.

Long Title ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, I will plead that we allow the Minister for Roads and Highways to move the Motion numbered 20 for the abridgement of time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before doing so, let me acknowledge the presence of students from Hope College. They are led by Thomas D. Kodo, Head of Department. They are from Gomoa East and are 90 in number.

[Students of Hope College were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker Then we have St. Adelaide International School, led by Bismark Tweneboah, a teacher. They are from Weija/Gbawe and are 156 in number. Hon Jerry Shaib, your students are here.

[Students of St. Adelaide International School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker On behalf of the House, I welcome you to Parliament. Please do have a fruitful visit.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I had made an application to you to grant leave for the Minister for Roads and Highways to move the Motion numbered 20 for abridgement of time on behalf of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice. He was here earlier, but he has to catch a flight.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Frontbench?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: The Minister for Roads and Highways is our Friend, so for that one we do not have a problem.

MOTION

Suspension of Standing Order 172 (1)

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza) *on behalf of the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice:* Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 172(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that when a Bill has passed through the Consideration Stage, the Third Reading thereof shall not be taken until at least one sitting day has elapsed, the Motion for the Third Reading of the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 may be *moved today*.

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now, the procedural Motion numbered 21.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, once again, I will ask for leave from you for the Minister for Roads and Highways to move the Motion numbered 21 for the Third Reading.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Shaibu Mahama?

3:48 p.m.

Question put Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

BILL — SECOND CONSIDERATION STAGE

24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): I am exceedingly grateful for that opportunity to take us back to clause 12. We are looking at clause 12 (2),

“The President may in writing, designate a Minister...”

Mr Speaker, I move to *delete* “or any other person”. For the purposes of oversight, any other person cannot be in Parliament to answer Questions if he is not a Minister. So, I pray that we *delete* “or any other person” under clause 12(2). I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Motion is to *delete* “or any other person” and it is for the consideration of the House. Yes, Hon Dr Kabiru?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, I would want to find out— We have a situation where Ministers responsible for a Ministry are not there and the President designates other Ministers to oversee for those particular Ministers. Just as we have in the case of the Ministry of Defence, where the Minister for Finance has been asked by the President to be the caretaker Minister for the Ministry.

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I come under Order 171, to take us back to look at clause 12.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, are you arresting the Third Reading Motion? What is the outstanding matter?

Mr S. Mahama: Yes, please. The outstanding matter will be that, because of the impact that the clause 24 would have on clause 12 and subsequently on 25—That is what I want to raise now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well—Hon Members, the Motion for the Third Reading has been arrested. The reason being that, the amendments carried on clause 24 would have an impact on clause 12.

So, Hon Members, we will then give the floor to the Chairperson of the Committee. So, the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 is now back to Consideration Stage and in this case, Second Consideration Stage. Chairperson of the Committee, you now have the indulgence of the House to do so.

MOTION

Request for the Second Consideration of the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025

Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): Mr Speaker, I beg to move that the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025, be taken through a Second Consideration Stage in respect of clause 12.

In this case, if we have the Minister designate, which has been defined in the interpretation section, being indisposed, are we then saying that the President would be responsible for that Authority? The challenge I have is that, can we not say, “any other Minister”, instead of just saying “any other person”? I understand what he wants to cure; however, the words “or any other Minister” can actually also be defined if we are so minded.

The difficulty is, if we leave it open, it means that oversight would come back to the President. Even though we all admit that the President has ultimate oversight over every arm of the Executive. But while we are creating the law, I think we should make it flexible for the President to appoint any other Minister, in the case where the Minister designated is not available.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Chairperson in moving the amendment indicated that the reason for this amendment is to *delete* “or any other person”. The reason is that, if any other person exists in the law, and such a person is designated, the law – and it is the practice – does not allow such a person for purposes of oversight to appear before us. That is the justification for “any other person” to be deleted.

Now, the clause is saying that the President may, in writing, designate a Minister. The meaning is that the President is not under obligation so to do. But when the President decides, he may designate a Minister. So, the person to be designated is already a Minister, exactly

what happened in the case of the Ministry of Defence.

The doctrine of necessity does not prevent the President from doing so. That is why the definition of a Minister designated in the Bill indicates clearly that it is the Minister referred to under clause 12(2). So, this is very clear and certain.

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, I am persuaded and I agree with the explanation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Question put amendment agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, consequentially and in addition to the “or any other person” under clause 12(3), *delete* “or any other person designated”. The new rendition is,

“The Minister under subsection (2) shall carry out the directives of the President.”

I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib Iddrisu, I believe this is a consequential amendment.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Yes, Mr Speaker, if it will not hurt since clause 12(2) reads,

“The President may in writing, designate a Minister...”

So, if we can change it to “the designated Minister under subsection (2)”, to cure whatever we were discussing in clause 12(2).

So, the new rendition in 12(3) would be,

“The designated Minister under subsection (2) shall carry out the directives of the President.”

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Alhaji Habib, your proposed amendment is good but it offends the brevity principle in drafting. Once you have defined the Minister to mean a Minister-designate, subsequently that person becomes the Minister. So everywhere you see the phrase “the Minister”, it is making reference to the Minister-designate.

Thank you very much.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

3:58 p.m.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, because we have discussed oversight. One of the oversights is authority responsible to the President and then the Minister responsible to Parliament. So, we do not want to leave the headnote as Executive Oversight. We want to amend the headnote to read “oversight” *simpliciter*.

Mr Speaker, I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. It is for the consideration of the House.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Now can I put a question on the entire clause?

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 12 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, the impact continues and is affecting regulations. Under 25 (1), “the Minister” I propose we *delete* “designated by the President under subsection 2 of section 12”. The new rendition will be the; “Minister may, on the advice of the board, by legislative instrument, make regulations generally for the effective and efficient implementation of this Act.”

Mr Speaker, I so move.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is for your consideration. This is also consequential so I would put the question.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Yes, Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr S. Mahama: Mr Speaker, gracefully we have finished and it is finished

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, when the Chairperson says, it is finished, I do not get it. The Bill has not been passed yet so why did he say it is finished? If he had said we have finished with the Consideration Stage, that would be alright. This is the reason why the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 will suffer because when we have not finished, they say we have finished.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, my question is limited to whether or not there is a further amendment to clause 25 so in the absence of any further amendment, I would put the question on the entire clause 25.

Clause 25 as amended, ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Hon Members, we have come to the end of the Second Consideration Stage. I would therefore call on the Minister for Roads and Highways to move the Motion numbered 21.

BILL — THIRD READING

24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move* that the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 be now read the Third Time.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion ably moved, any seconder?

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Shaibu Mahama): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

The 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025— *read the Third time and passed.*

[Hear! Hear!]

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I want to take the opportunity to congratulate Hon Dr Yaw Osei Adutwum. *[Laughter]* He promised to run a clean campaign and he campaigned well. Unfortunately, his Colleagues in the Chamber did not vote for him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, by what imagination did you know that his Colleagues in the Chamber did not vote for him? How did you know?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I followed the voting. He almost lost in the constituencies of all the Frontbenchers in the Minority, which is not very good. He is a very punctual person. In fact, he is still sitting in the Chamber. Maybe he would have been a better candidate than the person they chose but Hon Habib Iddrisu told me there is a reason they did not vote for him, so we would leave it at that.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, what the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways is saying that he got zero in our constituencies is not true. Mr Speaker, in my constituency, he got one vote—[*Laughter*]—So he cannot say it was zero votes. It is not true that he got zero votes in our constituencies—[*Laughter*].

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, clearly, that one vote could be your vote.

Yes, Majority Leader, any indication?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, while I was preparing to give an indication, I think Dr Mahamudu Bawumia has to investigate the conduct of Hon Habib Iddrisu. In the presence of Hon Adutwum, he is making an effort to show that there was one person that voted for him. Giving indication that it is likely that he is the one who voted for him.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank everybody for the support that we have received to pass the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025. So, the Bill is duly passed by Parliament, it will be forwarded to His Excellency the President for his assent. It is a major political promise of the National Democratic Congress (NDC) and it will pave the way for the expedited implementation of the 24-Hour Economy Policy. We promise and we deliver. Today marks another milestone

in the march towards delivering on all our manifesto promises.

Mr Speaker, on that note, I want to say we are in your hands. Today is Friday and we have not done five hours.

Mr Speaker, I move that this House adjourns to Tuesday two o'clock in the afternoon.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved for adjournment. Any seconder?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, to second the Motion, it is just a clear indication that the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 itself has already been defeated. Because we still have a lot of things to do after doing two hours. The Majority Leader is saying we should go home.

Mr Speaker, we second the Motion. We will help them, since the 24-Hour Economy Authority Bill, 2025 itself will not even survive two hours.

Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 4:10 p.m. till Tuesday, 10th February, 2026, at 2:00 p.m. in the afternoon.

Editor's Note

This *Official Report* was adopted by the House on 13th February, 2026.